

Student Guide — senior / module-10-herbs-aushadhi

IKS Curriculum

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Student Workbook

Student Workbook — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Senior)

This workbook is yours to write in. Use it for vocab, exercises, and reflection across all 10 days.

Vocabulary tracker

Fill in as we go:

- *auṣadhi* — _____
- *tulasī* — _____
- *nimba* — _____
- *haridrā* — _____
- *ādraka* — _____
- *yavānī* — _____
- *pudīnā* — _____

Day-by-day notes

Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 9 — Build the Class Deck

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment

What I learned:

One question I have:

Final reflection

After Day 10, write a paragraph: what is the most important thing you learned in this module?

Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: define auṣadhi and recognise the six herbs of this module.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *auṣadhi* (IAST: auṣadhi; lit. “medicinal plant / herb”)

Primary source (today’s reading)

From *Caraka Saṃhitā* — see `sources.md`.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see `activities/`). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces What is Auṣadhi?.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 2 — Tulasī — Holy Basil

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify tulasī by leaf and smell; name the active compound (eugenol).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See `lesson-plan.md` for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *tulasī* (IAST: *tulasī*; lit. “holy basil — *Ocimum tenuiflorum*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Tulsī — Holy Basil.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify nimba; learn about azadirachtin; understand high-dose safety warning.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student

- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *nimba* (IAST: nimba; lit. “neem — *Azadirachta indica*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Neem — Bitter Healer.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: distinguish fresh root vs powder; identify curcumin as active compound.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *haridrā* (IAST: haridrā; lit. “turmeric — *Curcuma longa*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Turmeric — Golden Root.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).

Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: distinguish fresh vs dried; gingerol vs shogaol.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *ārdraka* (IAST: ārdraka; lit. “ginger — *Zingiber officinale*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Ginger — Warming Root.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: recognise seeds and leaves; identify thymol; traditional digestive use.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *yavānī* (IAST: *yavānī*; lit. “ajwain — *Trachyspermum ammi*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Ajwain — Carom Seed.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: recognise several mentha varieties; identify menthol.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *puḍīnā* (IAST: puḍīnā; lit. “mint — *Mentha* spp.”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Mint — Cooling Leaf.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: categorise the six herbs by heating/cooling effect (links to module 4).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *auṣadhi* (IAST: auṣadhi; lit. “medicinal plant / herb”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Herbs and the Doṣas.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).

Day 9 — Build the Class Deck

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: each student contributes one identification card to the class library.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *tulasī* (IAST: tulasī; lit. “holy basil — *Ocimum tenuiflorum*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Build the Class Deck.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: present the class herb deck; take summative quiz.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *nimba* (IAST: *nimba*; lit. “neem — *Azadirachta indica*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Final Share and Assessment.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).

Writing Prompts

Writing Prompts — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Senior)

Use these for in-class writing, homework, or assessment. Each prompt is suitable for a 300-word response.

1. In 3–4 sentences, explain Herbs — Auṣadhi to a friend who hasn’t taken this module.
2. Choose one Sanskrit term from this module. Define it, then describe one observation from your own life that matches.
3. Compare Herbs — Auṣadhi with a similar concept from another module or from your science textbook. What’s similar? Different?

4. Identify ONE claim in this module that you'd want to test. How would you test it?
5. What was the most surprising thing in this module? Why did it surprise you?
6. Pick one source cited in this module. Write 2 sentences explaining why it matters.
7. What is one common misconception about Herbs — Auṣadhi? Rebut it in 2–3 sentences.
8. Imagine you are teaching this module to a younger student. What would you say first?
9. Read one primary-source passage cited in this module. Translate or paraphrase it; comment on what it adds to your understanding.
10. Identify a contemporary debate about the IKS framework presented here (e.g., is Tirthaji's mathematics genuinely Vedic? are doṣas a valid framework today?). Take a position with two pieces of evidence.

How to use

- Pick **one** prompt per day for the writing-prompts homework.
- Or assign all of them across the module, alternating between in-class and home.
- Senior students may treat any prompt as a 500-word essay topic.

Homework

Homework — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Senior)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 10–15 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
2. **Day 2 — Tulṣī — Holy Basil** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
3. **Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
4. **Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
5. **Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
6. **Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
7. **Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
8. **Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
9. **Day 9 — Build the Class Deck** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
10. **Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.